ANX-02 | Therapist guide only

Understanding the role of a response

ANX-02 | A flexible therapist framework, guided by assessment and agreements.

Purpose

Use one example to explore possible links between perceived threat, feelings, body sensations, responses and outcomes. Immediate relief with later costs may be a useful hypothesis, but do not assume it explains every response.

Before use

Return to ANX-01 and choose an example the client wants to understand. Core 2 distinctions may help. Examine external reality and needs before labeling behavior problematic.

A possible working sequence

Open with SES-S01 as needed and close with SES-S02, feedback and a clear plan.

1. Describe the moment and what preceded it, based on known facts rather than assumed explanations.

2. Explore the client's expectations, feelings and body sensations.

3. Ask what they did or did not do, and what the response aimed to achieve.

4. Distinguish immediate outcomes from later effects on worry and functioning.

5. Form a shared hypothesis about the response's role, noting missing information and alternative explanations.

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Examples for exploration, not ready-made tasks

Examples are fictional. A real client's circumstances, needs and wishes take priority.

Group	A conversation example
Children	A child asks again for a game rule's explanation. It may be unclear or reflect a communication need. Explore before attributing the request to repeated reassurance seeking.
Adolescents	A teenager repeatedly checks a message and misses an activity. Explore immediate benefits and later costs without deciding they must stop.
Adults	An adult delays a task for fear of mistakes. Examine temporary relief, later demands and any missing instructions or resources.
Older adults	A person requests accompaniment to an activity. This may enable participation and be necessary; unsupported independence is not an automatic goal.

A key distinction

Necessary caution, access measures, appropriate support and medical monitoring are not inherently problematic avoidance. Context and function matter. This observation form does not authorize stopping checks, accompaniment or treatment instructions.

A question for shared reflection

What does the response enable and cost in this case, and what information is still missing to understand it?

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Individual adaptation and scope

An age label does not replace assessment of development, communication, context and preferences.

Group	A possible approach
Children, approximately ages 6 to 11	Use a concrete situation and one question at a time. The therapist can write spoken answers and check understanding. Hear the child's voice too. Adult roles, sharing and consent depend on the setting and need; do not promise absolute confidentiality.
Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17	Choose a personal focus and recording method that respects privacy. Explore setting, demands and relationships. Explain sharing and consent limits, and arrange help without making practice a test or demand for obedience.
Adults	Include roles, culture, language, circumstances and resources as described. Do not assume time, money or support is available. Shared choice does not replace clinical suitability assessment.
Older adults	Use respectful adult language, comfortable pace and spacing. Ask about preferred completion methods and help without assuming reduced ability or family dependence. Life experience and preferences inform the work.

Checking understanding and choice

Ask the client to explain their understanding and choice in their words. Shorten, leave fields blank or answer aloud. If questions are unsuitable or burdensome, adapt the approach rather than require completion.

This unit's specific boundary

A cycle is a formulation tool, not a fixed chain or universal explanation. Body, emotion and environment interact. Leave unclear links open, continue exploration or choose another focus.

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Practice, follow-up and professional review

Practice is chosen jointly; the sheet does not automatically authorize action.

Before practice

ANX-02-P observes an agreed example without deliberately changing the response. Agree on a brief scope so observation does not become repetitive, burdensome monitoring.

Back in the session

Compare the hypothesis with actual events and differences across situations. If a maintaining cycle is supported, decide separately how to respond; do not remove a response merely because it appears on the form. ANX-03 can help select a type of response to worry.

Production and review status

Original draft guide and sheets. Professional review for each age and a rights review are needed before distribution. Completed writing is not clinical approval; the kit has not been validated or tested for effectiveness.

General sources for further reading

NICE CG113 — adults
Professional framework for adult generalized anxiety: assessment, functioning and work by trained therapists. It does not validate these six units or their use with children.
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg113/chapter/Recommendations

NIMH — child anxiety, 2024
Research background on CBT for children; the study used a different protocol. It does not approve this wording or these age adaptations.
https://www.nimh.nih.gov/news/science-updates/2024/cognitive-behavioral-therapy-alters-brain-activity-in-children-with-anxiety

Consulted: 03 Nov 2026. Background sources only, without permission to copy forms or validation of the kit.

Reviewer's name, role, date and versions reviewed:

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